None of these things had merited one comment, public or private, from my family.

I knew how they rationalized it all, saying it was no different from what Camilla got. Or Kate. But it *was* different. One study looked closely at four hundred vile tweets about Meg. Employing a team of data specialists and computer analysts the study found that this avalanche of hate was wildly atypical, light-years from anything directed at Camilla or Kate. A tweet calling Meg "the queen of monkey island" had no historical precedent or equivalent.

And this wasn't about hurt feelings or bruised egos. Hate had physical effects. There was a ton of science showing how unhealthy it is to be publicly hated and mocked. Meanwhile, the wider societal effects were even scarier. Certain kinds of people are more susceptible to such hate, and incited by it. Hence the package of suspicious white powder that had been sent to our office, with a disgusting racist note attached.

I looked at Granny, looked around the room, reminded them that Meg and I had been coping with a wholly unique situation, and doing it all by ourselves. Our dedicated staff was too small, too young, grossly underfunded.

The Bee and the Wasp harrumphed and said we should've let it be known that we were under-resourced.

Let it be known? I said I'd begged them repeatedly, all of them, and one of our top aides had sent in pleas as well—multiple times.

Granny looked directly at the Bee and the Wasp: *Is this true?*

The Bee looked her right in the eye, and, with the Wasp nodding vigorously in assent, said: *Your Majesty, we never received any of these requests for support.*

71.

MEG AND I ATTENDED the WellChild Awards, an annual event that honored children suffering from serious illnesses. October 2019.

I'd attended many times through the years, having been a royal patron of the organization since 2007, and it was always gutting. The children were so brave,